

Assignment 1: Dev 5

Before you start

- Make sure **Codex / OAI is running correctly in Hermes**. If it isn't, please reach out **asap — preferably today**.
- Set your model to **Sol 5.6 — Medium reasoning**. Astra uses quite a lot of tokens and is a bit overkill for this assignment.
- Install the following skills:
 - <https://github.com/mattpocock/skills>
 - <https://github.com/kepano/obsidian-skills>
 - [optional Coding related skills]
<https://github.com/mattpocock/skills> (full set)
 - <https://github.com/obra/superpowers> (read before installing)
- Also spend some time exploring the **Skills Hub** so you get a feeling for what is already available.

If you plan to do your research inside Hermes as well — **which I recommend** — create at least **two separate profiles**:

- **Coder**
- **Researcher**

Each profile should have its own **system prompt**. Have a look at the prompt guide, search online for some good examples, or **create in collaboration with your agent**. You can configure the profiles in the bottom-left corner under **Manage Profile**.

Make sure you select the right profile before starting a specific task.

Your **Researcher** profile can already make use of some of Hermes' built-in capabilities, including the research skill.

For your **Coder** profile, make sure the **Grill skill** from Matt Pocock is enabled. You can check this under **Capabilities → Skills**.

If anything up to this point is unclear, please reach out via **okarin_cawai on Discord** — recommended — or by email, which might be slightly slower.

Assignment: Build a Local Productivity System

Build a local **desktop productivity system** containing:

- a to-do app
- a Pomodoro / time-tracking app

You can either build **two separate apps** or combine them into **one application**.

Both need to:

- work offline
- save data locally
- log activity to a user-selected Obsidian vault

Step 1 — Research

Research at least:

- 3 to-do apps
- 3 Pomodoro / time-tracking apps

Keep track of your sources and identify:

- essential features
- useful vs unnecessary features
- 1–2 custom ideas you would like to bring into your own product

Step 2 — Grill session

Based on your research, explain your idea to your agent and ask it to use the **Grill skill**.

Answer the questions properly and use the session to work through your product idea.

By the end of this step, your agent should be able to generate a clear **spec sheet / PRD** for the project.

Step 3 — Design references

Create some design examples, sketches, wireframes, or mock-ups.

Place these inside a **reference folder** in your project.

You can then ask your agent to analyse these references and follow the visual direction when building the application.

Step 4 — Set up the project in Hermes

Create a dedicated project folder in Hermes and link the project to **Git / GitHub**.

Minimum requirements — To-do app

Your app must allow users to:

- create, view, edit and delete tasks
- complete and reopen tasks
- keep tasks after closing and reopening the app

Important actions should be logged to the Obsidian vault, including:

- task creation
- edits
- completion
- reopening
- deletion

Minimum requirements — Pomodoro/timetracking app

Your app must allow users to:

- start, pause, stop and complete focus sessions
- take breaks
- change focus and break durations
- connect a session to a task or short description
- review completed sessions

Log:

- session starts
- completed sessions
- cancelled sessions

Completed sessions should contain the **actual duration** and the linked task or activity.

Obsidian vault

Both apps must write clear and consistent **Markdown records** to an Obsidian vault selected by the user.

Every entry should contain:

- date, time and timezone
- event type and status
- relevant task or session information

Keep task and focus records organised in predictable folders.

The vault should work as an **append-only history**. Do not silently overwrite previous events.

All submitted records must have been generated by your actual apps.

PRD and design

Write a short PRD containing (results of grill session) :

- product name and purpose
- intended user and problem
- core features
- custom features
- non-goals
- main user flow
- testable acceptance criteria

Also explain your main technical and design decisions:

- framework
- local storage
- Obsidian vault structure
- screen layout
- usability decisions
- one alternative you considered but did not choose

Include at least **three meaningful visual artifacts** across both tools, for example:

- sketches
- wireframes
- mock-ups
- style studies

Briefly explain what each one helped you decide.

AI + GitHub

You can use AI for (everything):

- research
- design
- coding
- testing
- documentation

But you are still responsible for the final result. Check your sources, understand what the code is doing, and test the application properly.

Use **Git/GitHub** throughout the project.

- Two separate apps → two separate repositories
- One combined app → one repository

Each repository should contain a README with:

- setup instructions
- run instructions
- dependencies
- Obsidian vault configuration

IMPORTANT: Commit regularly and make sure the project works from a clean clone.

What to submit

1. Your GitHub repository link(s).
2. One report containing your research, PRD, design choices, visuals, vault examples, AI note and a short reflection. **If you work consistently inside Hermes, your agent should already be able to help you generate most of this (.pdf).**
3. A sample of the Obsidian vault containing **real entries generated by your app (.md).**
4. **Naming conventions :**

Yourname_3IXD_Dev5_PRD.PDF ,

Firstname_Lastname_3IXD_Dev5_Obsidiansample.md

If you get stuck on the setup or something in Hermes isn't working, reach out early rather than waiting until the assignment deadline.